

```
5.1M  ./My Stuff/Swap/VLC
14M  ./My Stuff/Swap
27M  ./My Stuff
17M  ./PDF Bangalore
82M  .
82M  total
```

The `-c` option here gives the grand total, and the `-h` option presents the size in human-readable form. What if you want this *du* listing of the file sizes in an ascending order? Try the following command:

```
sandeep@linux-17c8:~/Desktop> du -ch | sort -n
2.4M  ./My Stuff/Swap/Song
4.1M  ./My Stuff/Blender 2.46 review/images
4.2M  ./My Stuff/Blender 2.46 review
5.1M  ./My Stuff/Swap/VLC
5.9M  ./My Stuff/Swap/Avidemux
14M   ./My Stuff/Swap
17M   ./PDF Bangalore
27M   ./My Stuff
82M   .
82M   total
```

Compare the above output with the previous one—do you notice that the order of the directory listing has changed now? Piping the previous output to the *sort* command helps achieve this with the aid of the `-n` (numerical-sort) switch, which reorders the output based on the file sizes provided by the *du* command.

In this manner you can check the contents of the largest directory and see if there are any unnecessary files there. If so, delete them to free up space.

Another handy command is *df* that you can use to check the disk space usage on all mounted file systems:

```
sandeep@linux-17c8:~> df -h
Filesystem      Size  Used Avail Use% Mounted on
/dev/sda1        5.4G  2.5G  2.6G  50% /
udev            247M  180K  246M   1% /dev
/dev/sda3        28G   11G   16G  37% /home
```

Adding the `-h` flag to *df* presents the file sizes in a human readable form, viz. in KBs, MBs or GBs instead of 1K block sizes.

All this is pretty nifty, but let's face it: it's often difficult to work with command line tools when the disk space is large and the number of files are more. In this case the GUI tools such as KDirStat for KDE and Baobab for GNOME come to the rescue.

## KDirStat for directory statistics

KDirStat is a graphical disk usage utility similar to the *du* command with some additional cleanup features. Most of the Linux distributions have this software included in their software repositories. If it is not

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